

The First Sip Box

label & card system

Three teas. Three pouches. Three brew cards. One orientation. Specified for manual repackaging on Day 1, printable at home, ready for a co-packer at Day 90.

OWNER

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ROLE

Senior UI/UX Designer

STATUS

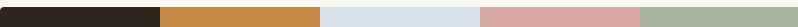
v1.0 · approved

DATE

May 2026

MATERIAL LAW

Matte paper world. Gloss only on the tea itself.



What's inside

Four sections. Each one ships an artifact you can hand to the repackaging operator on Day 1, and to a co-packer on Day 90 without changing a word.

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Names, locked.

Already specified in Curated Box Collection v1.0. This page confirms the lock-in with the rationale for each name and the role it plays in the trio.

BOLD · BLACK

Morning Dark

Rich, warm, morning-ready.

SOURCE	Cinnamon Orange Black, S&TE
CAFFEINE	●●●○ High
NOTES	Warm spice · Orange zest · Deep black
DISCLOSURE	Natural flavor enhanced
POUCH	Deep tea-leaf brown · amber band

WHY THIS NAME

Names the moment, not the leaf. "Morning Dark" sells the cup the coffee refugee is buying — the dark thing you reach for at 6:47 a.m. It carries the cinnamon-orange flavor without ever saying "cinnamon orange" on the front.

FLORAL · HERBAL

Lavender & Mango

Soft, fragrant, caffeine-free.

SOURCE	Lavender Mango Herbal, Trishnna
CAFFEINE	○○○○ None
NOTES	French lavender · Sweet mango · Warm rooibos
DISCLOSURE	Natural flavor enhanced
POUCH	Powder blue · blush accent

WHY THIS NAME

Honest as a perfume bottle. Two ingredients, an ampersand, a promise. The ampersand reads premium and quiet where "+" would read transactional. This is the only product whose name we treat as a small typeset piece, not a phrase.

SMOOTH · GREEN

Tangerine Grove

Light, clean, easy to brew.

SOURCE	Tangerine Green, S&TE
CAFFEINE	●●○○ Low-Medium
NOTES	Fresh tangerine · Grassy sencha · Clean citrus
DISCLOSURE	Natural flavor enhanced
POUCH	Sage paper green · cream label

WHY THIS NAME

Place over leaf. "Grove" carries warmth and sun without an origin claim — we don't say it grew in Sicily because it didn't. It promises the citrus, hides the sencha, and gives the beginner a flavor word to look forward to instead of a varietal to fear.

The five-element label.

One label rule for all nine teas. Same hierarchy, same type scale, same vertical rhythm. Only the color and the words change. Operator can build a new pouch in under a minute.

Substrate. Matte uncoated label stock, 60 lb opaque. Printed on a home/office laser printer Day 1, transitioning to a commercial litho run at Day 90. **No varnish, no foil, no gloss — ever.** The only gloss in the brand is the tea leaf, the brewed cup, and the glass jar.

Label trim. 90 mm × 105 mm (≈ 3.5" × 4.1"). Applied to the upper face of a 4 oz kraft stand-up pouch (110 mm × 165 mm pouch). Centered horizontally, top edge 12 mm from the pouch heat seal.

Color rule. Each label uses its pouch's base color as the dominant field, the accent color as a 6 mm band along the top edge, and the cream or paper-tone for legibility on the inside. **No image, no illustration on the label itself.** Decoration is reserved for the box and the website. The pouch is just true.

Type scale (printed at 100%). Brand mark: Instrument Serif italic 11 pt · Eyebrow: DM Sans 500 / 7 pt / 0.28 em tracked · Tea name: Instrument Serif 30 pt · Flavor notes: Instrument Serif italic 10.5 pt · Disclosure / caffeine label: DM Sans 500 / 7 pt / 0.18 em · Brew spec: DM Sans 500 / 8 pt · Net weight: DM Sans 500 / 7 pt.

HIERARCHY — TOP TO BOTTOM

- 1

Tea name

The largest mark on the label. Sentence case. Two words max, three if needed. Sits in the top third under a small "Drink Varitea" brand wordmark.

Instrument Serif · 30 pt · margin-top 28 mm
- 2

Flavor notes

Three flavor words, separated by middle dots. Italic. Promises the cup. Never describes origin, leaf grade, or claim.

Instrument Serif italic · 10.5 pt · margin-top 4 mm
- 3

Disclosure tier

12 px colored dot + UPPERCASE label in caption weight. Yellow for "natural flavor enhanced" on all three first-sip teas. The dot is the only place sentence case is broken — this is a regulatory affordance, not branding.

Dot 4 mm · DM Sans 500 / 7 pt · tracked 0.18 em
- 4

Caffeine label

Four-dot system (●●●○) plus word label. Same row, dots first then word. Lives in the middle band so it's never missed by a coffee-refugee scanning the shelf.

DM Sans 500 / 9 pt for dots · 7 pt / 0.18 em for word
- 5

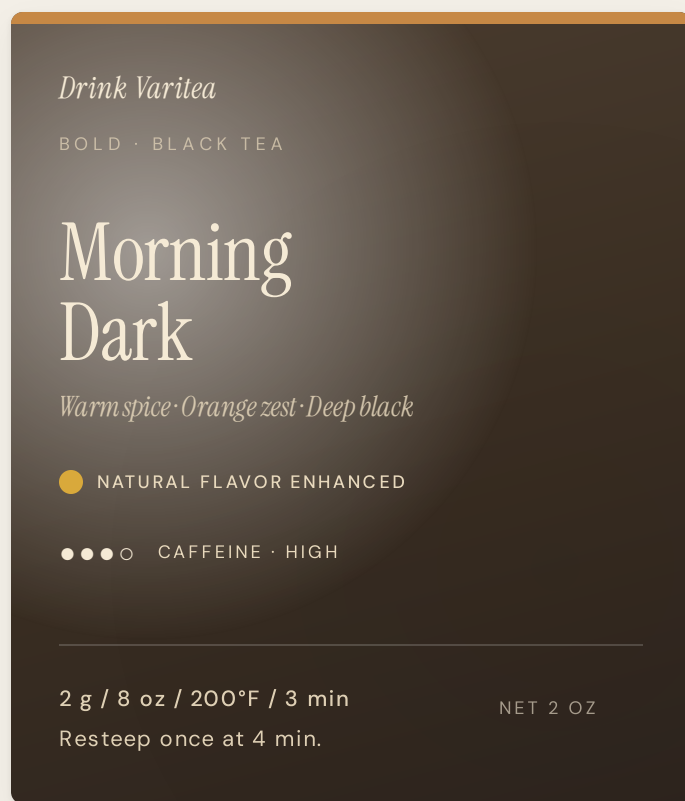
Brew spec block

Two lines, hairline rule above. Line 1: ratio / volume / temperature / time. Line 2: the one surprise that belongs on the pouch (resteeep, cold brew, bitterness warning). Net weight floats bottom-right of the same band.

DM Sans 500 / 8 pt · hairline 0.25 pt · padding-top 5 mm

The three labels.

Same hierarchy, three colorways. Shown at print-equivalent scale. Each carries its single surprise on the brew line — the one moment that helps a beginner not fail the first cup.



Morning Dark
deep tea-leaf brown · amber band



Lavender & Mango
powder blue · blush accent



Tangerine Grove

sage paper green · cream accent

The brew card.

3.5" × 2", matte card stock, business-card size. Front carries the tea, the brew, and the one surprise. Back carries the three-step ritual that turns a leaf into a cup. No claims, no origin myths.

FRONT — ANATOMY

- 1

Brand mark

Italic wordmark in caption size. Always top-left. Never grows.

Instrument Serif italic · 8 pt
- 2

Tea name

Sentence case, single line. The most-read element on the card.

Instrument Serif · 22 pt
- 3

Flavor chips

Three flavor words, each prefixed by an accent dot in the tea's color (amber / blush / sage). One row, no wrap.

DM Sans 500 / 7 pt · 0.08 em
- 4

Brew spec line

Ratio · volume · temperature · time. Always grams, never teaspoons. Always Fahrenheit. Reads like an instruction, never a suggestion.

DM Sans 500 / 11 pt · 0.04 em
- 5

The surprise

One italic line below a dotted rule. The discovery moment that makes the cup more than competent — resteeep for Morning Dark, cold brew for Lavender & Mango, the bitterness warning for Tangerine Grove. This is the only flourish.

Instrument Serif italic · 10 pt
- 6

Caffeine marker · disclosure

Dots bottom-left. Disclosure dot + UPPERCASE label bottom-right. The two regulatory affordances sit on the same baseline.

DM Sans 500 / 7 pt
- 7

Accent stripe

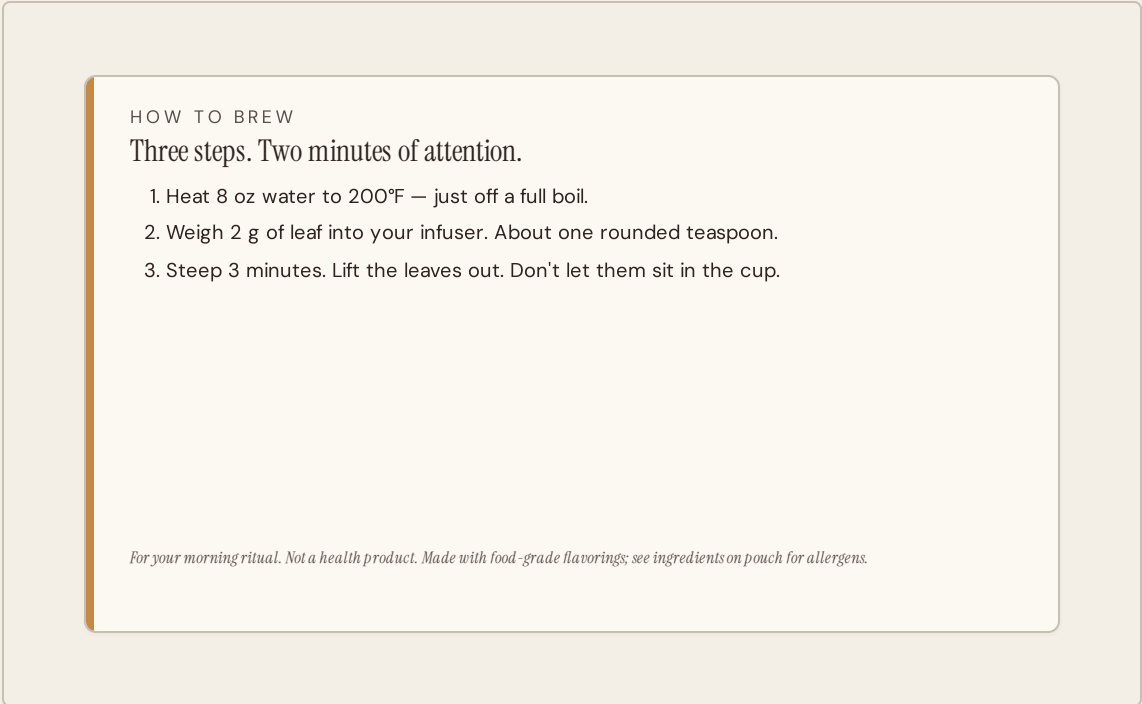
4 mm color rule on the left edge — amber, blush, or sage. The only piece of color on a cream card.

4 mm vertical · full-bleed left

FRONT · PRINTED AT SCALE



BACK · PRINTED AT SCALE



The three brew cards.

Front carries the cup; back carries the ritual. One surprise per tea, written to protect the beginner from the failure mode that ruins the first sip.

01 Morning Dark

surprise: resteeep

Drink Varitea

Morning Dark

●

WARM SPICE

●

ORANGE ZEST

●

DEEP BLACK

2 g · 8 oz · 200°F · 3 min

Resteeep once at 4 minutes — the second cup is rounder, less spice-forward.

●●●○

Caffeine · High

●

NATURAL FLAVOR ENHANCED

HOW TO BREW

Three steps. Two minutes of attention.

1. Heat 8 oz water to 200°F — just off boil.

2. Weigh 2 g leaf. About one rounded teaspoon.

3. Steep 3 min. Lift leaves out, don't let them sit.

For your morning ritual. See pouch for ingredients and allergens.

02 Lavender & Mango

surprise: cold brew

Drink Varitea

Lavender & Mango

●

FRENCH LAVENDER

●

SWEET MANGO

●

WARM ROOIBOS

2 g · 8 oz · 200°F · 5 min

Cold brew · 2 g / 12 oz / 8 hours in the fridge. The mango blooms overnight.

○○○○

Caffeine · None

●

NATURAL FLAVOR ENHANCED

HOW TO BREW

Three steps. Or eight quiet hours.

1. Heat 8 oz water to a full 200°F — herbal needs the heat.

2. Weigh 2 g. The lavender, mango and hibiscus should be visible.

3. Steep 5 min. The cup turns soft pink — that's the hibiscus.

Caffeine-free. See pouch for ingredients and allergens.

03 Tangerine Grove

surprise: bitterness warning

Drink Varitea

Tangerine Grove

●

FRESH TANGERINE

●

GRASSY SENCHA

●

CLEAN CITRUS

2 g · 8 oz · 170°F · 3 min

Not boiling. Bitterness begins at 4 minutes — set a timer the first time.

●●○○

Caffeine · Low

●

NATURAL FLAVOR ENHANCED

HOW TO BREW

Three steps. The temperature is the secret.

1. Heat water and rest it 90 seconds, or aim for 170°F.

2. Weigh 2 g of leaf. The orange peel should be visible.

3. Steep 3 min, lift out. Bitter past 4 — set a timer.

Low-medium caffeine. See pouch for ingredients and allergens.

Your first sip.

A 5" × 7" folded card. Front speaks. Inside teaches. One paragraph, three icons, three teas in the order they want to be drunk. The first thing the hand touches when the box opens.

FRONT — WHAT THE CUSTOMER SEES FIRST

Drink Varitea

Your first sip.

Start here.

Three teas, in the order they were meant to be drunk. Bold for the morning. Floral for the afternoon. Smooth for whenever you have the patience to notice it.

A FOUNDER'S BOX · NO. 001

INSIDE — THREE TEAS, THREE ICONS

THE THREE YOU HAVE

You don't need to taste these in order. But if you've never brewed loose-leaf tea, this is the order I'd brew them in.



Morning Dark — bold

First, because mornings carry permission for richness. 200°F, three minutes.



Lavender & Mango — floral

Second, in the afternoon. No caffeine. Cold brew it if it's warm out — give it eight hours.



Tangerine Grove — smooth

Last, when you have time. Water at 170°F — not boiling. Lift the leaves at three minutes or it turns bitter.

— The Varitea team. Houston, Texas. If you brew something wonderful, send us a photo.

Hand-off, in five lines.

The Brand Agent's Day-1 packet is closed. The Ecommerce Ops Agent picks up here, with everything they need to print, label, and ship the first box.

DECISION

Three names lock. One label hierarchy. One brew card system. One orientation card.

Morning Dark · Lavender & Mango · Tangerine Grove. Five-element label hierarchy. 3.5" × 2" brew card. 5" × 7" folded orientation card. Matte everywhere. No health, origin, or sourcing claims.

NEXT ACTION

Print one set on the home printer, photograph, send to first 10 founder customers.

Ops checklist:

- Print 30 pouch labels (10 per tea) on 60 lb matte uncoated label stock
- Print 30 brew cards (10 per tea) on 110 lb matte cover
- Print 10 folded orientation cards on 100 lb matte text
- Apply labels, fill pouches, photograph one finished trio in natural light

METRIC MOVED

First paid order readiness — yes.

All Day-1 packaging artifacts are now specified, designed, and printable on a home printer without commercial press setup. The Brand Agent is no longer a blocker on shipping the First Sip Box.

BLOCKERS

Allergen disclosures + nutrition panel — Ops owns.

Outstanding before any pouch goes to a paid customer:

- Confirm allergen statements from S&TE and Trishnna in writing
- Commission FDA-compliant nutrition panel for all three teas
- Net-weight verification on a calibrated kitchen scale

None of these block the design system. All of them block ship.

HANDOFFS

Ecommerce Ops · Web App · Lifecycle.

- **Ecommerce Ops Agent** — print run, packaging order, allergen + nutrition panel, photo set for Shopify product pages, founder fulfillment kit.
- **Web App Agent** — pull the same five-element hierarchy into the digital product cards. Use accent colors (amber / blush / sage) on the digital cards so the pouch and the website teach the same shape.
- **Lifecycle Agent** — the orientation card copy is the seed for the post-purchase email. Same voice, same three-tea order, same brewing surprise per tea.